

1635–1649

DOUBLET AND BREECHES

During this period France remained the centre of fashion. The doublet and breeches were still the main style of dress, often made from matching fabric. Gradually the waistline on the doublet became higher and the fabric tabs below the waist lengthened to create a jacket-like garment, which finished at hip level. The slashed effect remained popular with vertical openings down the front, back, and sleeves of the doublet. Breeches retained a fullness around the seat but were now worn longer on the leg, tapering below the knee and held in around the calf with a band, often decorated with bows. In the mid-1640s doublets and breeches became much shorter, with breeches gradually getting fuller, finishing in a straight line at the knee. Referred to as petticoat breeches, they resembled a skirt and were worn with underdrawers with decorative edging “canions” that hung beneath the hem.

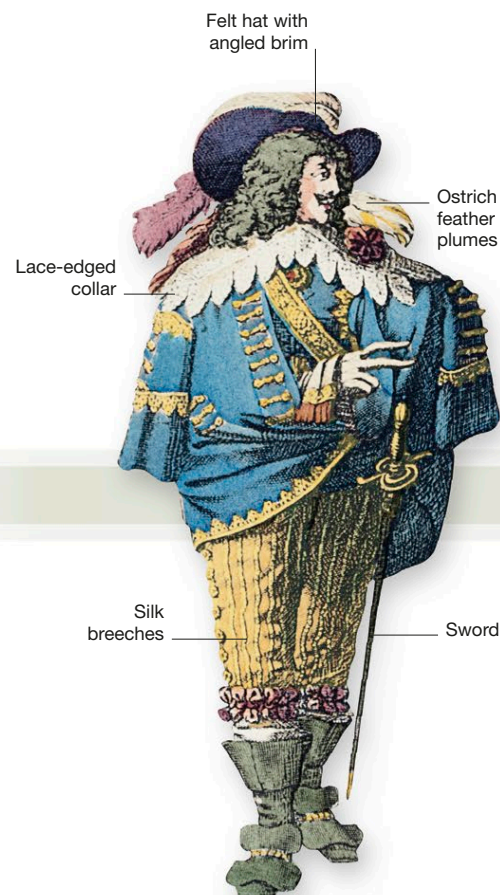
LACE



Lace continued to be a popular accessory for men and women. Originally developed as a scalloped trim on the edging of linen garments, gradually whole cuffs and large collars made of lace became fashionable. Patterns for lace were drawn up on paper and lace-makers, often families who handed down the skills, would work with fine linen threads to copy the designs. Lace was a highly valued personal possession – it was extremely costly as it took a long time to make even the smallest piece. The finest lace was produced in Italy, France, and the Flanders area of Belgium, and there was a strong international market for it as it was easy to transport and high in value.



Band collar Made from fine linen and often trimmed with costly lace edging, collars were an important accessory. The earlier ruff style was replaced with the flatter band, which draped softly from a high neckline, and cut straight across the back.



Feather in cap Hats were often decorated with trailing feathers such as ostrich plumes. These were placed on the left side of the hat leaving the right sword-arm free to move. Worn indoors, hats were removed before royalty and elders.



Boot fashion By the 1630s spurs developed into a leather butterfly shape at the front of the foot, becoming very large and dramatic in size. The top of boots began to widen and were known as cup shapes. By the 1640s these slouched down the leg.